

REBECCA M. M. HICKE

PHD CANDIDATE, COMPUTER SCIENCE, CORNELL UNIVERSITY

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EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ph.D. Candidate, Computer Science (expected) May 2027
Minor: Information Science Ithaca, NY
Committee: David Mimno (chair), Lillian Lee, Jon Kleinberg, Ross Kristensen-McLachlan
Thesis areas: Computational literary studies, natural language processing (NLP)

Cornell University, M.S., Computer Science October 2024
Minor: Information Science Ithaca, NY

Carleton College, B.A. *cum laude*, Computer Science and English June 2022
Minor: Digital Arts and Humanities Northfield, MN
Advisors: Eric Alexander and George Shuffelton
Received distinction in both majors

RESEARCH & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Cornell University August 2022 – present
Advisor: David Mimno Ithaca, NY
Areas: Computational literary studies, NLP

AI Research Scientist, AIIL Group, Microsoft Research November 2025 – January 2026
Advisor: Kiran Tomlinson Remote
Areas: Human-AI interaction, NLP

Research Intern, AIIL Group, Microsoft Research May 2025 – August 2025
Advisor: Kiran Tomlinson Redmond, WA
Areas: Human-AI interaction, NLP

Graduate Research Assistant, Aarhus University May 2024 – August 2024
Advisor: Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan Aarhus, Denmark
Areas: Computational literary studies, NLP

PiTech Research Fellow, Cornell University June 2023 – August 2023
Host Organization: Good Call NYC Remote
Areas: Data visualization, data analytics

Research Scientist , Authors AI	May 2023 – August 2023
Areas: NLP	Remote
Undergraduate Research Assistant , Carleton College	June 2020 – May 2022
Advisor: Eric Alexander	Northfield, MN
Areas: Data visualization, Human-computer interaction (HCI), digital humanities	
Undergraduate Research Assistant , UC Berkeley	June 2021 – March 2022
REU – Summer Undergraduate Program in Engineering Research at Berkeley	Remote
Advisors: Sarah Chasins and Aditya Parameswaran	
Areas: HCI, NLP	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record , Cornell University	June 2026 – August 2026
INFO 1100: Introduction to Programming	
<i>Designed course and materials (available on my website)</i>	
Guest Lecturer	
Text Mining History and Literature, Cornell University	August 2026
<i>taught by David Mimno</i>	
NLP for Cultural Analytics, University of Colorado Boulder	September 2025
<i>taught by Maria Antoniak</i>	
Natural Language Processing, Carleton College	October 2024
<i>taught by Eric Alexander</i>	
How LLMs Work: Their Potential and Limitations, Cornell University	October 2024
<i>taught by David Mimno</i>	
Research Group Instructor and Mentor , Cornell University	Spring 2024 – Spring 2025
Content Analysis and Large Language Model Assisted Narrative Research	
<i>Co-designed and directed research course, mentored 8 students</i>	
Graduate Teaching Assistant , Cornell University	August 2023 – present
INFO 3350: Text Mining History and Literature (1 term)	
CS/INFO 4300: Language and Information (1 term)	
<i>Received Outstanding TAing Award</i>	
CS 2110: Object-Oriented Programming and Data Structures (1 term)	
CS/INFO 3300: Data-Driven Web Applications (1 term)	
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant , Carleton College	March 2020 – June 2022
CS 111: Introduction to Computer Science (1 term)	
CS 201: Data Structures (4 terms)	

PUBLICATIONS

* Represents undergraduate mentees at the time of publication

Peer-Reviewed Conference and Journal Publications

Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and Kiran Tomlinson. 2026. "Adopt $\neq$ Adapt: Longitudinal Analyses of LLM Conversations in the Wild." *Proceedings of the 2026 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M., Brian W. Haggard, Mia Ferrante,* Rayhan Khanna,* and David Mimno. 2025. "Are You There God? Lightweight Narrative Annotation of Christian Fiction with LMs." *Proceedings of the 6th Computational Humanities Research Conference*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M., Yuri Bizzoni, Pascale Feldkamp, and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2025. "Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization." *Proceedings of the 6th Computational Humanities Research Conference*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M., Sil Hamilton, and David Mimno. 2025. "The Zero Body Problem: Probing LLM Use of Sensory Language." *Proceedings of the 2nd Conference on Language Modeling*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and David Mimno. 2025. "Looking for the Inner Music: Probing LLMs' Understanding of Literary Style." *Expanding the Toolkit: Large Language Models in Humanities Research – Computational Humanities Research*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2024. "SCIENCE IS EXPLORATION: Computational Frontiers for Conceptual Metaphor Theory." *Proceedings of the 5th Computational Humanities Research Conference*.

Finalist – Best Short Paper Award

Kristensen-McLachlan, Ross Deans, Rebecca M. M. Hicke, Márton Kardos, and Mette Thunø. 2024. "Context is Key(NMF): Modelling Topical Information Dynamics in Chinese Diaspora Media." *Proceedings of the 5th Computational Humanities Research Conference*.

Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and David Mimno. 2023. "T5 meets Tybalt: Author Attribution in Early Modern English Drama using Large Language Models." *Proceedings of the 4th Computational Humanities Research Conference*.

Book Chapters

Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and David Mimno. 2024. "'Let every word weigh heavy of her worth':

Examining How Women Enact Power in Shakespeare's Comedies through Interactive Speech Pattern Visualizations." In *Computational Drama Analysis: Reflecting Methods and Interpretations*. De Gruyter.

Workshop Publications

- Hamilton, Sil, Rebecca M. M. Hicke, Mia Ferrante,* David Mimno, and Matthew Wilkens. 2026. "Too Long, Didn't Model: Decomposing LLM Long-Context Understanding with Novels." *Proceedings of the 10th Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*.
- Hamilton, Sil, Rebecca M. M. Hicke, Matthew Wilkens, and David Mimno. 2025. "A City of Millions: Mapping Literary Social Networks at Scale." *Proceedings of the 5th International Conference on Natural Language Processing for Digital Humanities*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M. and David Mimno. 2024. "[Lions: 1] and [Tigers: 2] and [Bears: 3], Oh My! Literary Coreference Annotation with LLMs." *Proceedings of the 8th Joint SIGHUM Workshop on Computational Linguistics for Cultural Heritage, Social Sciences, Humanities and Literature*.
- Hicke, Rebecca M. M., Maanya Goenka, and Eric Alexander. 2022. "Word Clouds in the Wild." *Proceedings of the IEEE 7th Workshop on Visualization for the Digital Humanities (Vis4DH)*.

Under Review

- Hicke, Rebecca M. M., Sil Hamilton, David Mimno, and Ross Deans Kristensen-McLachlan. 2026. "The Plot Thins: Uniformity and Linearity in Literary Summaries." *Under review at CHR 2027*.
- Bax, Axel, Sanghoon Oh, Rebecca M. M. Hicke, Matthew Wilkens, and David Mimno. 2026. "Judging a Cover by its Book." *Under review at CHR 2027*.

SERVICE

Workshop Organizer: NLP for the Digital Humanities [NLP4DH] (2025)

Session Chair: CHR (2023)

Reviewer: LaTeCH-CLfL (2024, 2025, 2026), DH (2024, 2025, 2026), CHR (2023, 2026), CHR Journal (2025), Open Research Europe (2023), Journal of Computational Literary Studies (2023)

Mentoring and Outreach:

ACSU Research Night (2023, 2024, 2025)

Recruited graduate presenters for outreach getting students interested in research
Student-Applicant Support Program (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025)

Provided feedback on application materials for applicants to Cornell CS PhDs
New Visions in Engineering (2022-2023, Coordinator: 2023-2024)

Mentored high school students interested in futures in engineering + CS research
Bowers Undergraduate Research Experience (BURE) (2023)

Mentored and organized social events for undergraduate research assistants
Program Assistant, Carleton College (June 2022 – August 2022)

Mentored and supervised students in History of Computing Study-Abroad Program
Residential and Program Assistant at UT Austin (2018 – 2020)

Academy for Women – formerly First Bytes (2 sessions)

Academy for All – formerly Code Longhorn (1 session)

Academy for Robotics (2 sessions)

Academy for Cybersecurity (1 session)

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

Future Leaders in Liberal Arts AI Education Travel Grant, <i>Harvey Mudd College</i>	May 2026
Foundational AI PhD Fellowship, <i>Cornell University</i>	January 2026 – May 2026
Hopcroft Fellowship, <i>Cornell University</i>	2022 – 2023
Laurence McKinley Gould Prize in Natural Science, <i>Carleton College</i>	May 2022
David John Field Prize, <i>Carleton College</i>	May 2022
The David Pollatsek '96 Prize in Computer Science, <i>Carleton College</i>	May 2022
<i>Distinction</i> – Computer Science Senior Thesis, <i>Carleton College</i>	May 2022
<i>Distinction</i> – English Senior Thesis, <i>Carleton College</i>	April 2022
Thorsen Scholarship, <i>Carleton College</i>	2020 – 2022
Larson International Fellowship, <i>Carleton College</i>	2021

CERTIFICATIONS & SUPPLEMENTAL TRAINING

(Re)Imagining Liberal Arts & STEM Education in the Age of GenAI, Harvey Mudd College <i>Conference on adapting education in response to the proliferation of AI</i>	May 2026
Early Career Graduate Teaching Cohort, Cornell University <i>Workshop series on developing teaching skills</i>	Spring 2026

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

"Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization," April 2026
Quid deinde? New Ideas and Approaches to AI & DH, University of Montreal

"How to Read Books with AI: AI and Narrative Analysis," *University of Richmond* March 2026

Conference Talks

"Says Who? Effective Zero-Shot Annotation of Focalization," *CHR 2025* December 2025

"Are You There God? Lightweight Narrative Annotation of Christian
Fiction with LMs," *CHR 2025* December 2025

"SCIENCE IS EXPLORATION: Computational Frontiers for Conceptual
Metaphor Theory," *CHR 2024* December 2024

"T5 meets Tybalt: Author Attribution in Early Modern English Drama Using
Large Language Models," *CHR 2023* December 2023

Workshop Talks

"Word Clouds in the Wild," Vis4DH @ IEEE Vis October 2022

"Examining How Women Enact Power in Shakespeare's Comedies through
Interactive Speech Pattern Visualizations," *Workshop on Computational Drama Analysis* September 2022

Poster Presentations

"The Zero Body Problem: Probing LLM Use of Sensory Language," *COLM 2025* October 2025

"[Lions: 1] and [Tigers: 2] and [Bears: 3], Oh My! Literary Coreference
with LLMs," *LaTeCH-CLfL 2024* March 2024

"Large Language Models and NER: Better Results with Less Work," *DH 2023* July 2023

"T5 meets Tybalt: Author Attribution in Early Modern English Drama Using
Large Language Models," *TADA 2023* November 2023